Elena Benini

PostDoc Researcher at the University of Zurich: Homepage
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Education

Postdoctoral Researcher, Psychology — *University of Zurich*
Field: Cognitive and Experimental Psychology — *June, 2026 - Present*

First Assistant (Postdoc), Psychology — *University of Lausanne*
Field: Cognitive and Experimental Psychology — *August, 2025-May, 2026*

Postdoctoral Researcher, Psychology — *RWTH Aachen*
Field: Cognitive and Experimental Psychology — *June, 2024 - July, 2025*

PhD Candidate, Psychology — *RWTH Aachen*
Field: Cognitive and Experimental Psychology — *November 2019 - May 2024*
Supervisors: Andrea M. Philipp, Ph.D., Iring Koch, Ph.D.
Dissertation title: The role of feature binding and episodic retrieval processes in task switching with a special focus on binding and retrieval of task-irrelevant contextual features.
Defense date: May 14th, 2024

M.Sc. in Applied Experimental Psychological Sciences — *Milan-Bicocca University, Milan*
Final grade: 110/110 with distinction — *October 2019*

Bachelor degree in "Psychology and Mental Health" — *"La Sapienza" University, Rome*
Final Grade: 110/110 with distinction — *July 2017*

Academic experience

Invited Talks Klaus Rothermund's lab at Jena Unversity (January 2026) • David Dignath's lab at Tübingen University (planned Dec 2025) • Andrea Kiesel's lab at Freiburg University (8th May 2025) • Wilfried Kunde's lab at Würzburg University (9th December 2024) • Martin Fischer's lab at Postdam University (online), March 2024 • Jan de Houwer and Senne Braem's labs at Ghent University (in person), January 2024 • Christian Frings' Lab at Trier University (in person), February 2024 • Tamar Gollan's lab at University California San Diego (online), January 2024.

Teaching Currently supervising a Master's thesis. • At the University of Lausanne, teaching assistant for a Bachelor's course in statistics and for a Master's course on an introduction to Bayesian statistics. • At Aachen RWTH University, taught hands-on course (experiment design, data analyses with R, results interpretation) in Psychology Bachelor for 5 semesters. April 2021 - July 2023. • Supervised three Bachelor's theses.

Lab Visit February 2025, 8-weeks lab visit at the University of Zurich with Klaus Oberauer. • September 2022, four-weeks lab visit at the University of Passau, Germany, with Susanne Mayr and Malte Möller.

Professional Service

Peer Reviewer	Reviewed more than 10 empirical articles for the following outlets: • Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning Memory and Cognition • Psychonomic Bulletin & Review • Bilingualism: Language and Cognition • Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance • Journal of Cognition • Attention, Perception & Psychophysics • Memory & Cognition • Psychological Research • Frontiers • Cognitive, Behavioural, & Affective Neuroscience • Scientific Reports • Current Psychology • Riewever for CogSci conference in 2025 and 2026
Special Issue	Serving as a co-guest editor, with Luca Moretti (lead) & Julie Bugg (supervision), for a Special Issue on JEP:LMC (link) on conflict adaptation in single and multitasking paradigms.
Symposia	Co-organized a 2-days Symposium with Dr. Luca Moretti about conflict adaptation in single- and multi-tasking paradigm. Seven guests joined us in Aachen from the US, Belgium, Italy, France and Germany (4th-5th July, 2025). • Organized and chaired a double symposium about feature binding and episodic retrieval at the TeaP conference in Trier in 2023 and in Regensburg in 2024 (with Tom Verguts and Mengqiao Chai from Ghent University among the invited speakers).
Online Meetings	Organized an online meeting of the Women+ in Control group, with prof. Miriam Gade, prof. Eva Van den Bussche and dr. Kerstin Froeber and served as chairperson.

Grants & Awards

Networking Travel Award	Awarded by the Women in Cognitive Science+ to cover the travel to the Psychonomics 2026 (ca. €1,000).
Individual Research Grant	Awarded by the "Foundation for the University of Lausanne" to fund a project proposal including 2 experiments (ca. €3,250).
Juan de la Cierva Scholarship	Awarded by the Spanish government to fund a two-years Postdoc (ca. €75k) - Declined.
RWTH Start-Up Grant 2024	Received funding for a project proposal including 4 experiments and a lab visit (ca. €16k, $\text{StUpPD}_4 83-24$)
DFG International Events Grant	Co-organizer for a Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (German Research Foundation) grant to fund an international symposium in Aachen that was awarded to Luca Moretti (ca. €3,600, MO 4887/3-1).

Publications

Benini, E., Dignath, D., Schiltenwolf, M., Koch, I., Philipp, A. M., & Kiesel, A. (2026). Repeating Task-Irrelevant Contexts Does Not Bias Task Choice and Performance in Voluntary Task Switching. *Journal of Cognition*, *9*(1), 1–22. https://doi.org/10.5334/joc.512

Benini, E., Hazeltine, E., Weissman, D. H., & Koch, I. (2026). Evidence for the contribution of a signalling heuristic during cued task switching: Increasing the number of response alternatives can reduce response-repetition costs. *The American Journal of Psychology*, *139*(1), 15–26. https://doi.org/10.5406/19398298.139.1.03

Strivens, A., Lavric, A., **Benini**, E., Philipp, A. M., & Koch, I. (2025). The effect of preparation on binding between spatial and non-spatial features of voices in a multitalker setting. *Psychological Research*, *89*(2), 88. https://doi.org/10.1007/s00426-025-02103-6

Benini, E., Koch, I., & Philipp, A. M. (2024). Repetition costs in task switching are not equal to cue switching costs: evidence from a cue-independent context. *Psychological Research*, *88*(3), 910–920. https://doi.org/10.1007/s00426-023-01904-x

Benini, E., Möller, M., Koch, I., Philipp, A. M., Qiu, R., & Mayr, S. (2024). Evidence of task-triggered retrieval of the previous response: a binding perspective on response-repetition benefits in task switching. *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*, *31*(3), 1290–1300. https://doi.org/10.3758/s13423-023-02409-9

Frings*, C., Beste*, C., **Benini***, E., Möller*, M., Dignath, D., Giesen, C. G., Hommel, B., Kiesel, A., Koch, I., Kunde, W., Mayr, S., Mocke, V., Moeller, B., Münchau, A., Parmar, J., Pastötter, B., Pfister, R., Philipp, A. M., Qiu, R., ... Schmalbrock, P. (2024). Consensus definitions of perception-action-integration in action control. *Communications Psychology*, *2*(1), 7. https://doi.org/10.1038/s44271-023-00050-9

Benini, E., Koch, I., Mayr, S., Frings, C., & Philipp, A. M. (2023). Binding of task-irrelevant contextual features in task switching. *Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology*, *76*(8), 1872–1888. https://doi.org/10.1177/17470218221128546

Mocke, V., **Benini**, E., Parmar, J., Schiltenwolf, M., & Kunde, W. (2023). What is behind partial repetition costs? Event-files do not fully occupy bound feature codes. *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*, *30*(4), 1463–1474. https://doi.org/10.3758/s13423-023-02253-x

Benini, E., Koch, I., Mayr, S., Frings, C., & Philipp, A. M. (2022). Contextual features of the cue enter episodic bindings in task switching. *Journal of Cognition*, *5*(8), 1–17. https://doi.org/10.5334/joc.220

Contreras-Saavedra, C. E., Willmes, K., Koch, I., Schuch, S., **Benini**, E., & Philipp, A. M. (2020). Multilingual two-digit number naming: The influence of composition rules on language switching. *Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology*, *73*(9), 1481–1494. https://doi.org/10.1177/1747021820916108

Papageorgiou, K. A., **Benini**, E., Bilello, D., Gianniou, F.-M., Clough, P. J., & Costantini, G. (2019). Bridging the gap: A network approach to Dark Triad, Mental Toughness, the Big Five, and perceived stress. *Journal of Personality*, *87*(6), 1250–1263. https://doi.org/10.1111/jopy.12472

*shared first authorship

Manuscripts in preparation or submitted

Benini, E., Moeller, M., Mayr, S., Koch, I., Qiu, R., Grange, J., Philipp, A. M., and Moretti, L. (under review, preprint) Response selection can feed back on task selection through episodic retrieval

Benini, E., Mocke, V. (under review) Spatial Numerical Associations in the Absence of Lateralized Codes: Magnitude Processing Creates Horizontal Biases in Vertical Mouse Movements

Benini, E., Koch, I., Mayr, S., and Philipp, A. M. (under review) Context binding in language switching.

Vandendaele, A., **Benini**, E. (Preregistered Report - under review first stage) Dissociating stimulus- and response-level processes in the reading flankers paradigm

Conferences Attended as a Presenter

Psychonomics annual meeting, San Diego, 2026. Talk: "Binding overlapping features in procedural and declarative working memory"

Teap, Tübingen 2026. Talk: "Competition for shared features causes interference: Evidence for code occupation in declarative and procedural working memory."

ESCoP, Sheffield, 2025. Symposium Talk: "Episodic retrieval in task switching: Repeating the response induces retrieval of the task"

Teap, Frankfurt 2025. Symposium talk: "Is cognitive control adjusted to deal with partial repetitions in task switching?"

Psychonomics annual meeting, New York, 2024. Poster: "Episodic retrieval in task switching: Repeating the response induces retrieval of the task"

Teap, Regensburg 2024. Symposium talk: "Evidence of episodic retrieval in task switching: Repeating the response retrieves the task and vice versa"

NeuroMi, annual meeting of Milan center for neuroscience, Milan, 2023. Poster: "Compositionality of neural representations of logical rules: an fMRI study"

Psychonomics annual meeting, San Francisco, 2023. Poster: "Evidence of Task-triggered retrieval of the previous response: A binding perspective on response-repetition benefits in task switching"

Meeting of the DFG-funded Research Unit "Binding and Retrieval in Action Control" with international guests, Trier 2023. Talk and poster on the topic "Binding of task-irrelevant contextual features in task switching: Results and perspectives"

Teap, Trier 2023. Symposium talk: "A Repeating task retrieves the previous response in task switching.". Attended pre-conference workshop about an introduction to bayesian statistics with JASP

Psychonomics annual meeting, Boston, 2022. Poster: "Binding of task-irrelevant contextual dimensions in language switching."

NeuroMi, annual meeting of Milan center for neuroscience, Milan, November 2022. Poster: "Putting pieces together: how logical connectives combine propositions. An fMRI study."

ESCoP, Lille, 2022. Symposium talk: Benini, E., Koch, I., Mayr, S., Frings, C., Philipp, A.M. Binding of task-irrelevant contextual features in task-switching.

Teap, Cologne (online), 2022. Talk: "Binding of task-irrelevant cue features in cued language-switching."

Psychonomics annual meeting, New Orleans (online) 2021. Poster: "Binding of task-irrelevant contextual features in task switching."

ADok conference for PhD students, Würzburg, June 2021. Talk: "Is language bound in task switching when it is task-irrelevant?"

Teap, Ulm (online), 2021. Talk: "Binding of task-irrelevant contextual features in task-switching.". Attended pre-conference workshop about Multinomial Processing Tree Models.

Summer/Winter Schools and Workshops

Amsterdam, July 2024. "Model-Based Neuroscience and Cognition Summer School".

Mannheim, June 2023. "An introduction to cognitive modelling" workshop organized by the Statistical Modeling in Psychology (SMiP) program.

TeaP 2022 (online), pre-conference workshop: "Multinomial Processing Tree Modeling: Basic Methods and Recent Advances"

Milan (online), December 2022. "Intensive course on the analysis of power"

Hamburg (online) September 2021. "Cognitive Modeling Academy Hamburg" (CMAH) An introduction to cognitive models and hands-on exercises about reinforcement learning models and drift diffusion models.

Chalmers (online) September 2020. Workshop organized by the IDEA League about "Analysis and Modelling of Road User Behavior".

Technical skills

Programming Languages/Tools RStudio, Python, git, Matlab, MS office package, multiTree

Language proficiencies

Italian	Native
English	Very fluent
Spanish, German	Intermediate